

Intelligence Report

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Executive Summary

A cyber fraud network targeting Sabarimala pilgrims has been identified, using fake booking websites and UPI payments to defraud over 80 victims from Kerala, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka. The scammers operate from Haryana with a local syndicate in the know of the situation. Authorities are coordinating between Haryana and Kerala Police for investigation.

Key Findings

- Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre flagged a fraudulent cyber pattern targeting pilgrims ahead of religious seasons.
- A fake Sabarimala accommodation booking website, darshanmokshahomestay.in, defrauded over 80 pilgrims by collecting payments via UPI to a Haryana-based mule account.
- The police have received over 80 complaints against this fraudulent site. Victims from Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka paid advances through UPI.

Recommendations

- Issue an advisory warning about fake Sabarimala booking websites ahead of the Makaravilakku season.
- Alert pilgrims on social media platforms regarding the scam involving Telegram groups like @mandalam_yatra_deals and @sabarimala_booking_vip.
- Continue monitoring UPI transactions for irregularities from shell entities in Tamil Nadu.

Source Citations

- <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/i4c-pilgrim-cyber-fraud-alert-2026>
- <https://www.manoramaonline.com/news/kerala/pathanamthitta-pilgrim-fraud-2026>
- <https://reddit.com/r/LegalAdviceIndia/comments/tuv012>
- <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/sabarimala-booking-fraud-advisory-2026>